



故宮的故事

The Story of the Palace Museum

Part 2 · History, Preservation & Curators

ICS Creator Academy · Summer 2026

How old is the Palace Museum? 故宮幾歲了？

1406



Built as the Forbidden City 紫禁城建成

Emperor Yongle of the Ming Dynasty ordered its construction. It took 14 years and 1 million workers!

1925



Became a public museum 成為博物館

After the last emperor left, it was opened to the public as the National Palace Museum.

1949



Treasures flew to Taiwan 文物飛到台灣

During the civil war, 600,000+ treasures were packed and shipped to Taiwan for safekeeping.

1965



New museum opened in Taipei 台北新館開幕

The Taipei Palace Museum opened on Double Ten Day — and that's the one we visited!



How do you think the workers felt carrying 600,000 treasures onto ships?

How Are Treasures Protected? 文物怎麼被保護？

Museums work very hard to keep artifacts safe for thousands of years!



Temperature Control 溫度控制

Special rooms keep the temperature at exactly 18-20°C. Too hot or too cold can crack ancient materials!



Humidity Control 濕度控制

Humidity is kept at 50-60%. Too dry = cracks. Too wet = mold. Everything must be perfect!



Special Lighting 特殊燈光

UV light destroys colours and materials. Museums use special LED lights that protect artifacts.



Gloves Only! 只能戴手套

Even tiny amounts of oil from your fingers can damage artifacts. Every person who touches them wears gloves!



Safe Storage 安全收藏

Most artifacts are stored in acid-free boxes in underground vaults. Only 1% is on display at a time!



Regular Check-ups 定期檢查

Scientists examine each artifact regularly — like going to the doctor — to make sure nothing is deteriorating.

What is a Curator? 策展人是什麼？



A curator is the person who looks after a museum's collection and creates exhibitions.



Research 研究

Study the history of each artifact — where it came from, who made it, what it means.



Organise 整理

Keep records of every single object in the museum. The Palace Museum has 695,000+!



Design exhibitions 設計展覽

Decide WHICH objects to show, WHERE to put them, and HOW to tell their story.



Write labels 撰寫說明

Write the information cards next to each artifact — short, clear, and interesting!



Teach the public 教育大眾

Run tours, talks, and workshops to help visitors understand what they're looking at.



Work with scientists 與科學家合作

Collaborate with conservators and scientists to protect and restore damaged artifacts.

Would YOU be a Good Curator? 你適合當策展人嗎？ 🤔



Love learning

You enjoy reading and researching — you WANT to know everything about history and art.



Creative eye

You think carefully about how things look, and you enjoy making spaces beautiful and interesting.



Good communicator

You can explain complicated things in a simple, fun way that makes people excited to learn.



Very organised

You like having everything in order — records, labels, dates, and details all matter to you.



Team player

You work well with scientists, designers, teachers, and other museum staff.



Care about culture

You feel that history and art are important, and you want to share them with the world.



Which trait is your strongest? Which do you need to work on?



Design Your Own Exhibition! 設計你的展覽！

If YOU were a curator at the Palace Museum, what would your exhibition look like?

1

Choose a theme 選主題

What is your exhibition about? Ancient food? Famous women? Weapons? Art?

2

Pick 3 artifacts 選3件文物

From today's lesson — which 3 would you put in your exhibition and why?

3

Write a title 取名字

Give your exhibition a cool name that makes people want to come in!

4

Design the entrance 設計入口

Draw or describe what visitors see when they walk in. Make it exciting!



Share your exhibition idea with the class — be a real curator!



You've completed the Palace Museum Series!

故宮系列課程完成！



Artifact Expert



Museum History Pro



Junior Curator

Next up: 自來水博物館 Water Resources Museum 💧